VENKATA REDDY CHERUKULA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Entry-level SOC Analyst (Tier 1) candidate with hands-on lab experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), log analysis, network traffic inspection, and alert triage using Splunk and Wireshark. Trained in incident response fundamentals, Windows and Linux security monitoring, and the MITRE ATT&CK framework through the TryHackMe SOC Level 1 pathway. Pursuing CompTIA Security+ and Cisco CCNA certifications. Brings a civil engineering background with strong documentation discipline and regulatory-compliance rigor, well suited to SOC reporting standards and OT/ICS-adjacent security environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Security Monitoring & Detection: SIEM log analysis, alert triage, phishing identification, threat detection fundamentals, MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Incident Response: IR lifecycle fundamentals, alert prioritization and escalation, security event documentation
- Windows Security: Event Log analysis (Event IDs 4624/4625/4648/4720/4732/7045), registry persistence indicators, PowerShell abuse patterns
- Networking: TCP/IP, OSI model, DNS, DHCP, subnetting, packet/traffic analysis
- Security Frameworks & Concepts: MITRE ATT&CK, Red/Blue/Purple team fundamentals, Governance Risk & Compliance (GRC) awareness
- Tools & Platforms: Splunk (SIEM), Wireshark, Nmap, VirtualBox
- Operating Systems: Windows, Ubuntu Linux (administration & CLI)

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS

SOC Simulation Lab — VirtualBox + Ubuntu Linux

- Configured and administered a virtualized lab environment using VirtualBox and Ubuntu Linux to simulate core SOC operational workflows.
- Deployed and configured Linux-based security and monitoring tools within an isolated sandbox environment for hands-on practice.
- Applied Linux command-line administration — filesystem navigation, log inspection, and process/network monitoring — to support security operations tasks.
- Documented lab build steps and configurations to ensure repeatability and support future troubleshooting.
- Established a stable foundational environment for ongoing practice in networking, log analysis, and security tool deployment.

Network Traffic Analysis — Wireshark

- Captured and analyzed 500+ network packets across DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, and ICMP protocols using Wireshark.
- Investigated packet-level traffic to distinguish normal communication patterns from anomalous behavior.
- Applied capture and display filters to isolate protocol-specific traffic for targeted analysis.
- Examined TCP three-way handshake sequences, DNS query/response flows, and HTTP session data to build foundational traffic-analysis skills.p
- Documented traffic patterns and analysis findings to support incident-investigation readiness.

SIEM Log Monitoring — Splunk

- Built and configured 3 Splunk dashboards to monitor failed login attempts and DNS query activity.
- Monitored authentication and DNS logs to detect indicators of suspicious activity.
- Conducted simulated phishing-detection exercises, analyzing email headers and log data to correctly flag 10+ phishing attempts.
- Practiced alert triage workflows — prioritizing, investigating, and escalating simulated security events.
- Documented detection findings and triage outcomes in alignment with SOC reporting standards.

HANDS-ON LABS

- Splunk (SIEM): Dashboard creation, log ingestion review, alert triage practice
- Wireshark: Live packet capture, protocol filtering, traffic pattern analysis
- Linux (Ubuntu): Command-line administration, log file inspection, system/network monitoring
- VirtualBox: Virtual lab environment setup and configuration
- Nmap: Basic network scanning and host discovery
- Network Traffic Analysis: DNS, TCP/IP, HTTP/HTTPS, and ICMP protocol inspection

TRAINING & CONTINUED LEARNING

- TryHackMe — SOC Level 1 Path (in progress): SIEM fundamentals, log analysis, incident response, threat intelligence
- Studied Windows security event monitoring, registry-based persistence techniques, and PowerShell abuse detection
- Studied core Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) concepts and Red/Blue/Purple team security models

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Security+ — In Progress
- Cisco CCNA — In Progress

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Civil Engineering — R.V.R. & J.C. College of Engineering *Jun 2022 – May 2026*

Acharya Nagarjuna University | Guntur, Andhra Pradesh | CGPA: 7.52/10